low-DAT writers, having access to 1 GenAI idea improves a story's novelty by 6.3% and having access to 5 GenAI ideas yields improvements of 10.7%. Similarly, writers with access to 1 and 5 GenAI ideas produce stories that are evaluated more highly on usefulness by 5.5% and 11.5%, respectively. Similar improvements exist for certain story characteristics. For low-DAT writers in the *Human with 5 GenAI ideas* condition, assessments of how well the story was written increase by up to 26.6%, enjoyment of the story increase by up to 22.6%, and how boring the story is decreases by up to 15.2%. These improvements in the creativity of low-DAT writers' stories put them on par with high-DAT writers. In short, the *Human with 5 AI Ideas* condition effectively equalizes the creativity scores across less and more creative writers.

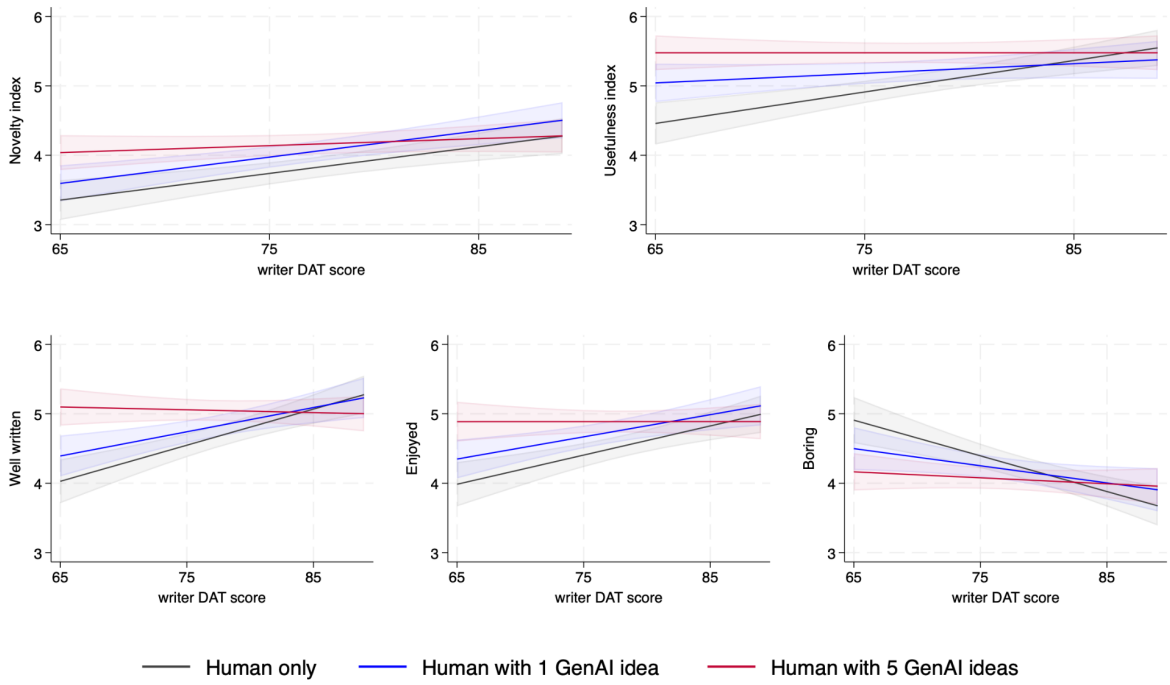

Figure 3. Marginal effect of writer's inherent creativity (as measured by DAT score) on the creativity indices and on select emotional characteristics by condition.

Ownership and profit-sharing. After asking evaluators to review each story for creativity and their emotional reactions, we ask evaluators to estimate to what extent each of the stories they just evaluated may have been influenced by GenAI (on a 100-point scale). We find that evaluators are able to assess whether stories received AI assistance (*Human with 1 GenAI idea*: b=6.21, p<0.001; *Human with 5 GenAI ideas*: b=4.96, p<0.001; see Table S12), though we do not find that they are more or less likely to attribute stories from writers with access to 5 GenAI ideas as being affected by GenAI, compared to those with access to 1 GenAI idea (p=0.3053).

Next, we disclose to evaluators whether GenAI ideas were made available to the writer of each story[13] and, if so, the GenAI ideas are shown alongside the final story. We ask evaluators how

much ownership should be attributed to the writers for their final story, an index we compute based on their answers to questions about the extent to which a story reflects the writer's own ideas and their claim to ownership (Figure 4). Figure 4A shows that, for stories that were produced by writers who had access to GenAI, evaluators attribute substantially less ownership to the writer. Using the ownership index, evaluators ascribed 25.4% less ownership to authors who had access to one GenAI idea, relative to writers in the *Human only* condition (b = –1.96, p<0.001, see Table S13; compared to the *Human only* mean of 7.74). The ownership discount is even higher for writers who had access to up to five GenAI ideas, at 31.0% (b = –2.40, p<0.001).

Following the questions on ownership, we elicit beliefs from evaluators about how hypothetical profits from selling the short story should be shared. We ask this question only for stories in the *Human with 1 AI idea* and *Human with 5 AI ideas* conditions and only if the writer requested at least one GenAI idea. We ask evaluators to indicate what percent of the story's profits should belong to the writer of the story versus the creator of the GenAI tool. We find that evaluators only impose a marginally significant penalty of 2.3% to writers who had access to 5 GenAI ideas (b= –2.30, p=0.072, see Table S14), relative to having access to 1 GenAI idea. Furthermore, this weak relationship is no longer statistically significant when we include as a control variable the extent to which the evaluator ascribes ownership of the story to the writer in both conditions. A one standard deviation increase in the ownership index results in an additional 16.2% of profits allocated to the writers (b=7.70, p<0.001).

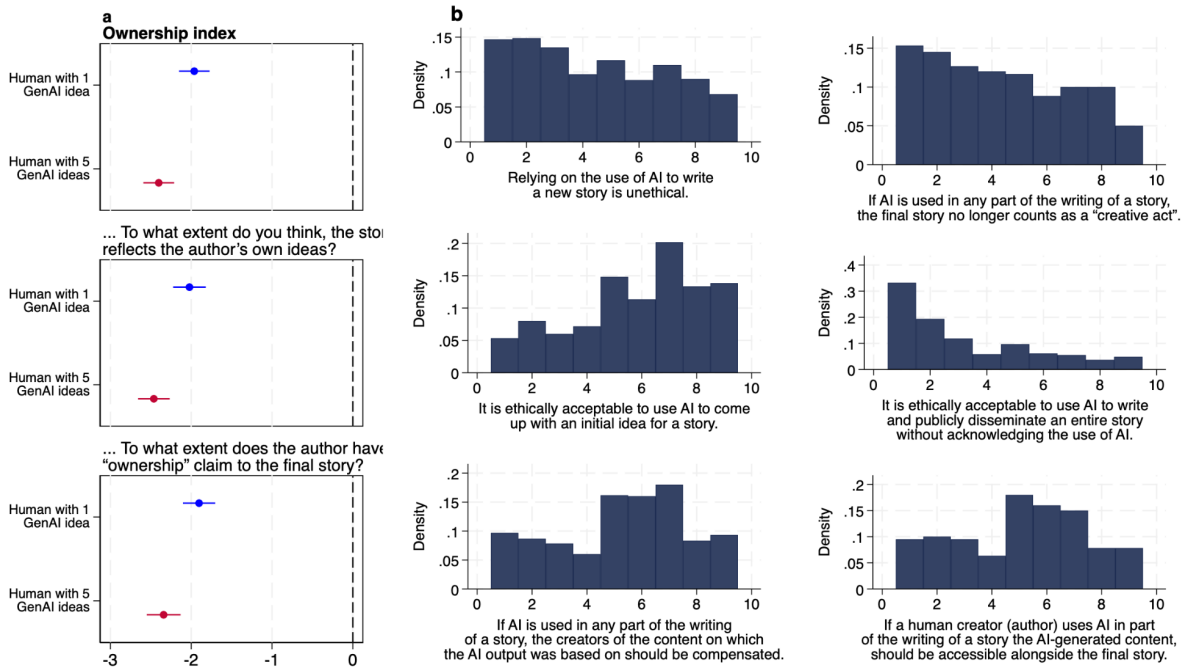

Figure 4. Evaluator assessment of ownership and attitudes toward genAI. **a**, Compares ownership index (and constituent components) of *Human only* (reference category) to humans with access to 1 and 5 GenAI ideas. **b**, summary of evaluator survey responses on attitudes toward genAI in creativity output.

GenAI and ethics in the creative process. We ask evaluators to indicate to what extent, and how, GenAI should be used to inspire stories in the future. We are interested in understanding the extent to which participants believe using GenAI is ethical and should be credited in the creative process. The responses to six exploratory questions are summarized in Figure 4B.

Evaluators in our sample tended to disagree with the ideas that the use of GenAI in story writing is unethical (52.7% scored 1 to 4 versus 35.7% scored 6 to 9; we focus on choices other than 5, since 5 is the scale midpoint, which might represent a neutral—i.e., indecisive—stance; see Tables S15 and S16) and that the story ceases to be a "creative act" if AI is used in any part of the story writing process (54.5% versus 33.8%).

However, according to evaluators, there were limits in the acceptability of the use of AI. While evaluators tended to agree that using AI for an initial idea was acceptable (26.5% versus 58.7%), they overwhelmingly tended to disagree with the idea that AI could be used for a story without acknowledgement of its use (70.2% versus 20.2%). There was also consensus that the content creators on which the AI output was based ought to be compensated (32.2% versus 51.7%) and, to a lesser extent, that the AI-generated content should be disclosed alongside the final story (35.3% versus 46.7%).

Similarity of stories. Thus far, we have focused on the subjective evaluation of third-party readers; now we turn to a more objective measure of the stories' content, in order to understand how GenAI affects the final stories produced. Using embeddings (*20*) obtained from OpenAI's embeddings application programming interface (API), we are able to compute the cosine similarity of the stories to the generated AI ideas as well as similarity to all other stories within condition (Figure 5). We multiply the cosine similarity score by 100 to arrive at a measure that ranges from zero to 100.

For stories in the *Human only* condition or in one of the GenAI idea conditions where the writer chose not to generate an idea, we randomly assigned an GenAI idea from the pool of ideas (that were created for other writers) within the same story topic. For writers in the two GenAI idea conditions who used the GenAI idea idea, we selected the first available idea. Then we tested how similar the stories were to the GenAI ideas. Relative to *Human only*, writers in the *Human with 1 GenAI idea* and *Human with 5 GenAI ideas* conditions wrote stories that were 5.2% (b=4.29, p<0.001, see Table S17; compared to a *Human only* mean of 82.85) and 5.0% (b=4.11, p<0.001) more similar to the GenAI ideas, respectively. In short, writers in the two GenAI conditions are anchored to some extent on the GenAI idea presented to them. To put these values in context, consider that in the *Human only* condition, similarity scores span a range of 17.67 points; therefore, a 4.29 increase in similarity from having access to one GenAI idea represents 24.3% of the total range.

We also look at the similarity of any one story to the "mass" of all stories within the same condition by computing the cosine similarity of the embedding of the focal story with the average embedding of all other stories in the same condition. Our results show that having access to GenAI ideas